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SOLVIX

Management of Information Technologies

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Project Description:

Solvix is a simple online platform that helps Zalando manage customer complaints in a clear and organized way.

It keeps all complaints in one place, makes communication between departments easier, and helps employees resolve issues faster. The system is also beneficial for customers, as it allows them to submit complaints easily, track their status, and receive quicker responses. This improves both company efficiency and customer satisfaction.

GitHub: https://github.com/simona-cholakova/Solvix

1. Project Client

ZALANDO - Online Retail Company

2. Importance

As a large European e-commerce company, Zalando processes thousands of customer orders daily. Complaints related to delivery delays, returns, refunds, and damaged products require structured and efficient handling.
Implementing a Complaint Management System will:

- → Improve customer satisfaction
- → Reduce complaint resolution time
- → Improve internal communication between departments
- → Strengthen customer trust and brand reputation

3. Purpose & objectives

- → **Purpose:** To develop a web-based system for managing and tracking customer complaints.
- → **Objectives:**
    - Enable customers to submit complaints online

- Categorize complaints by type (refunds, late delivery, damaged product…)
- Assign complaints to responsible departments
- Allow status tracking (Pending, In Progress, Resolved)
- Generate management reports
- Reduce resolution time

4. Possible Requirements of the Contracting Authority

→ **Description of the Methodology:** The project will follow Agile methodology with short development cycles and continuous feedback.

→ **Techniques & technologies used:**
- Frontend: React
- Backend: Node.js / Express
- Database: MySQL
- REST API integration

→ **Description of the Finished Product:** The final system will include:
- Complaint submission form
- Admin dashboard
- Complaint status tracking
- Department assignment feature
- Basic analytics and reporting module

→ **Reporting and Final Report:**
- Weekly progress reports
- Final technical and functional documentation
- Testing and evaluation report

5. Project Limitations (Options)

→ **Rough Schedule (3 months total):**
- Month 1:
  - Requirements analysis

        - System design
        - Database design
    - Month 2:
        - Frontend and backend development
        - API integration
    - Month 3:
        - Testing
        - Bug fixing
        - Deployment and documentation

→ **Available Funds:**
    - Estimated budget: ***€30,000***
    - *Sponsor:* ***Zalando***

→ **Milestones:**
    - Requirements approved – End of Week 2
    - Prototype ready – End of Month 2
    - Final release - End of Month 3

6. Project Management

→ **Project Manager:** Simona Cholakova

→ **Team Members:**
    - Backend Developer - Jaka Hrvatin
    - Frontend Developer - Nade Belovinova
    - QA Tester - Ema Čikotić

7. Date of Order: 21.02.2026

8. Client: Zalando

9. Signature: _____

Personas

Persona 1:

Demographic

Age	45
Gender	Female
Marital Status	Married
Income	€70.500
Experience	18 years
Employment type	Full-time
Digital Skill Level	Advanced

Anna Wattson

Customer Care Manager at Zalando

Quotes:

"With the right organization, every complaint leads to growth."

Screening question: Do you manage customer complaints, assign them to departments, track their status, and use digital tools to improve resolution and team performance?

Function: Customer Care Manager at Zalando (Responsible for complaint handling and team performance)

About Anna:

Anna Wattson is the Customer Care Manager at the headquarters of Zalando in Berlin, Germany. She goes to work Monday to Friday from 9am to 5pm. She oversees the daily work of the customer service team. She makes sure customer complaints and problems are handled quickly and properly. She approves the goals set by the team to ensure customer satisfaction and works closely with them to consistently achieve those goals.

Anna's main focus is monitoring and lowering complaint resolution time, keeping track of customer satisfaction scores, and team performance metrics. Anna reviews complex complaints, makes final decisions on refunds or compensations, and ensures consistent communication with customers and maintains the company's reputation.

Anna is flexible, enthusiastic and eager to make her career number one priority in her life. She is always keen on new technology that makes her work life easier and more beneficial for her team and the customers. She believes that excellent customer service is key to business success and that learning from complaints helps improve future performance.

Thinks	Emma wants complaints to be handled **quickly, efficiently, and fairly**. She believes the current process could be **more organized** and transparent. She thinks **any new technology should be easy to use and not hard to learn**, so her team can adopt it quickly.
Sees	She monitors **team dashboards, reports, and past complaint data** to see patterns and bottlenecks. She learns about improvements from **industry best practices, other e-commerce companies, and internal reviews**.
Feels	Emma feels **frustrated** when complaints pile up or resolution is delayed and especially when she doesn't know the current status of the complaints. She feels **satisfied and motivated** when her team resolves complaints efficiently and customers leave positive feedback. She wants to **empower her team** and make their work easier and more efficient.
Does	She **reviews escalated complaints** daily, where some of them have no structure at all. She **assigns complaints to the right departments** and monitors their status. She **generates reports** to analyze recurring issues and team performance. She **communicates with team members** to provide guidance on complaint resolution.

Problem Scenarios	Current Alternatives	Value Proposition
"I need a clear overview of all customer complaints and their current status."	I use spreadsheets, emails, and manual tracking to monitor complaints. This takes time, information gets lost, and it's hard to see real-time progress.	Keep all complaints in one centralized dashboard with real time status tracking, making monitoring faster, clearer, and more organized.
"I need to make sure complaints are assigned to the right department quickly."	I manually forward emails or contact departments separately. This causes delays, miscommunication, and sometimes duplicated work.	Allow direct department assignment within the system, improving internal communication and reducing resolution time.
"I need to reduce complaint resolution time and improve customer satisfaction."	I manually review complaint records and follow up with departments to check progress. This delays decision-making and makes it hard to identify bottlenecks quickly.	Offer real time complaint tracking and insightful analytics, enabling to quickly detect delays, lower response times, and therefore enhance customer satisfaction.

Persona 2:

Demographic

Age	34
Gender	Male
Marital Status	Single
Income	€50.000
Experience	7 years
Employment type	Full-time
Digital Skill Level	Mediocre

Lukas Weber
Accountant at Zalando

Quotes:
"Returns are part of the business model. But when they hit after the cutoff, they hit my sleep too."

Screening question: Does your role involve handling or adjusting financial reports due to customer complaints, refunds, or returns?

Function: Financial Accountant responsible for revenue reporting and return adjustments

About Lukas:

Lukas Weber is a Financial Accountant at an e-commerce company similar to Zalando. He is responsible for revenue reporting and month-end closing, where customer returns and complaints directly impact financial results. Lukas often feels stressed when late returns or refund requests arrive after reporting deadlines, forcing him to make last-minute adjustments. He values accuracy, predictability, and better visibility into complaint trends to reduce financial volatility and pressure during closing periods.

Lukas prefers structured systems and clear communication between departments to avoid last-minute financial adjustments. He values transparency and early visibility into refunds and complaints so he can prepare accurate reports. Better access to real-time complaint data would reduce stress during month-end closing and improve financial forecasting.

Thinks	Lukas wants to know about complaints and returns as soon as possible so he can re-adjust finances.
Sees	He sees late customer complaints that enter the system after deadlines, making reports less accurate.
Feels	Stressed during the month closing reports, because he anticipates last

	minute changes and is frustrated that he does not have insight into them sooner.
Does	Contacts customer service to clarify any uncertainties and build an excel report to estimate return provisions.

Problem Scenarios	**Current Alternatives**	**Value Proposition**
“It’s the last day of the month, and Lukas has already closed the books. Two days later, a batch of delayed customer complaints is processed by customer service. Many of them include refund approvals for high-value items.”	At the end of every month I contact the Customer service department to ask them about any new complaints.	Keep all complaints in one centralized dashboard with real time status tracking, making monitoring faster, clearer, and more organized.
“During month-end closing, Lukas receives multiple emails from customer service about unresolved complaints. The information is incomplete, spread across systems, and not standardized.”	I manually format the information provided to me and then handle the accounting after.	Keep all complaints in one place and already formatted to reduce manual overhead.

Persona 3:

Demographic

Age	19
Gender	Female
Marital Status	Single
Income	€500(monthly allowance)
Employment type	Student (Not employed)
Digital Skill Level	High

Dorothy Novak

First year student in Slovenia

Quotes:

"If something goes wrong, fixing it shouldn't take hours."

Screening question: Have you ever experienced a technical error with a promotional code and sought a quick way to report it and track the resolution?

Function: Zalando customer (student shopper)

About Dorothy:
Dorothy is a first year student at the Faculty of Arts in Ljubljana, Slovenia.
Like most students, she lives on a tight budget and treats herself to new clothes,shoes or accessories only when there is a good sale or a discount code available. She is a frequent Zalando shopper because of the variety and the convenience of home delivery. Recently, she received a promotional code via email that explicitly stated it was valid for the next 15 days.
She spent her evening carefully picking out a pair of sneakers and a jacket, planning to purchase them the next morning after the lecture. However, when she tried to apply the code less than 24 hours later, the system rejected it as "expired".
For Dorothy this isn't just a technical glitch; it's the difference between being able to afford the items or having to empty her cart. She is frustrated and feels misled by the marketing, but she doesn't want to spend hours on a phone line or send redundant emails. She wishes the fix to her problem was just a few clicks away and didn't require many social interactions.

Thinks	Dorothy thinks that large companies should honor their advertisements. She believes that if a system error occurs, the company should provide a replacement code immediately. She wants a platform where she will know that her complaints will be immediately heard and acted upon.

Sees	She sees influencers posting about “limited time” deals and feels pressure to shop fast, but she also sees “broken” customer service links that lead nowhere.
Feels	Feels annoyed and “cheated” out of a deal. As a student, she is price sensitive, so the loss of a 30% discount feels significant. She feels anxious about whether she will get a response before the items she wants sell out.
Does	She takes a screenshot of the original email (showing the 15 day validity) and the error message in her cart. She looks for a “Contact Us” or “Submit Complaint” button that doesn’t require a long phone call.

Problem Scenarios	**Current Alternatives**	**Value Proposition**
“I have proof that my code should work, but the checkout page says it’s expired. I need to show someone my screenshot”	Searching for a hidden customer service email or waiting in a live chat queue for 40 minutes.	Quickly upload her screenshot via a dedicated complaint form, ensuring her evidence is seen by the right department.
“I submitted a complaint through email, but I have no idea if anyone is looking at it. I’m afraid the sneakers will go out of stock.”	Refreshing email inbox constantly and hoping for a non-automated reply.	Use the Status Tracking feature to see that her complaint is “In Progress”, giving her peace of mind that resolution is coming.

User stories and prototyping

Persona 1 : Anna Watson, the Customer Care Manager

Epic Story: As a team leader, I want one simple screen to see and assign all incoming complaints, so I can make sure my team is working on the right things and no customer is left waiting.

User story	Test cases
As a Customer Care Manager, I want to see all customer complaints in a centralized dashboard so that I can quickly monitor their status and manage them efficiently.	**TC1: Make sure** all complaints are displayed in a dashboard. **TC2: Make sure** each complaint shows ID, customer name, complaint type, status, department and submission date. **TC3: Make sure** complaints can be filtered by status, department, or complaint type.
As a Customer Care Manager, I want to assign complaints to the appropriate department so that issues are handled by the correct team.	**TC1: Make sure** a department dropdown is available when viewing a complaint. **TC2: Make sure** the assignment can be saved. **TC3: Make sure** the complaint appears in the assigned department's queue.
As a Customer Care Manager, I want to track the status of complaints so that I can ensure they are resolved within an acceptable time.	**TC1: Make sure** complaint status is visible (Pending, In Progress, Resolved). **TC2: Make sure** departments can update complaint status. **TC3: Make sure** the resolution time is recorded and displayed.

Persona 2: Lukas Webber, the accountant

Epic story: As a financial accountant, I want to have full transparency and structured access to all financially relevant complaints, so that I can eliminate manual tracking, reduce stress during month end closing and ensure the company's financial reports are 100% accurate.

User story	***Test cases***
As a Financial Accountant,I want to view a real time list of complaints categorized as **"Refunds"** or **"Returns"** (or else)**,** so that I can identify potential financial liabilities before they hit the books.	**TC1:** Verify that the dashboard allows filtering by "Complaint Type" (e.g., Refund, Damaged Product). **TC2:** Ensure that each financial complaint displays the specific **Order Value** and **Requested Refund Amount**. **TC3:** Confirm that the dashboard status updates automatically when a Customer Care agent approves a refund. **TC4:** Verify that a "Closing Date" filter exists, allowing Lukas to see only complaints submitted within the current fiscal month.
As a Financial Accountant, I want to export complaint data into a structured CSV or Excel file, so that I can import the data directly into my accounting software without manual re-formatting.	**TC1:** Verify the existence of an **"Export to CSV/Excel"** button within the reporting module. **TC2:** Confirm that the exported file contains the following mandatory columns: `Complaint_ID`, `Status`, `Amount`, `Date_Approved`, and `Order_ID`. **TC3:** Ensure that the export includes a **"Status"** flag **(e.g., "Pending" vs "Resolved")** to help differentiate actual payouts. **TC4:** Verify that the system generates a success message or notification once the file is ready for download.
	TC1: Verify that the reporting module includes a **"Monthly Refund Summary"**

As a Financial Accountant, I want to receive a summary report of all approved refunds for the current month, so that I can easily reconcile them with the financial statements.	**option**. **TC2:** Ensure the report lists **Complaint ID, Order ID, Refund Amount, Approval Date, and Status**. **TC3:** Confirm that Lukas can **filter the report by month and year**. **TC4:** Verify that only complaints with **status = Resolved/Refund Approved** appear in the report.

Persona 3 : Dorothy Novak, the Student

Epic Story: As a busy student, I want a quick way to report my issue and see exactly what is happening with it, so I can get my discount fixed without wasting time on phone calls or checking my email constantly.

User story	***Test cases***
I want to upload proof (like screenshots) when submitting a complaint, so that the support team can quickly verify my issue and resolve it.	**TC1:** The user can **attach files** to the complaint form. **TC2:** The file is visible to the support team handling the complaint.
I want to track the status of my complaint, so that I know whether it is being processed and don't have to constantly check my email.	**TC1:** The complaint has statuses like **Submitted, Seen, In-Progress, Resolved.** **TC2:** Users can view the complaint status in their account and receive **push notifications** whenever the status is updated. **TC3:** The **complaint status updates automatically** when support takes action.
As a customer, I want to receive a clear resolution or response to my complaint directly on the platform, so that I don't have to communicate through multiple emails or support channels.	**TC1:** Verify that the system allows support staff to **send a response or resolution message directly within the complaint page**. **TC2:** Ensure that the customer can **view the response when they open their complaint in their account**. **TC3:** Confirm that the response clearly shows **the resolution details** (e.g., replacement promo code, refund approval, explanation). **TC4:** Verify that the system **marks the complaint as "Resolved" once the resolution message is sent**. **TC5:** Ensure the customer can **acknowledge or confirm the resolution** (for example with a "Mark as solved" button).

User Interviews and Prototyping

People interviewed:

Person	Role	Relation to system
Eva Petrushevska	Zalando user	Represents regular e-commerce users
Darko Cholakov	Accountant	Represents financial staff who need visibility into complaints
Alja Eremic	Zalando user	Represents regular e-commerce users

Interview 1 - Accountant:

Name: Darko Cholakov
Age: 40
Position: Financial Accountant at a mid-sized online retail company
Experience: 6 years in accounting

Questions & Answers

Q1: Do customer complaints affect your financial reporting?
A: Yes, complaints that lead to refunds or returns directly impact revenue reporting and monthly financial statements.

Q2: How do you currently receive information about refund complaints?
A: Usually through emails or Excel files sent by the customer service team.

Q3: What problems do you experience with the current process of receiving complaints?
A: Information sometimes arrives late or in different formats, which requires manual adjustments.

Q4: Would access to a centralized system with all complaints help your work?
A: Yes, it would make it easier to track refunds and prepare financial reports, only if the learning curve is easy enough to accommodate quickly.

Q5: What information about complaints is most important for financial analysis?
A: Complaint type, price, refund amount, and approval date.

Q6: Would the ability to filter complaints by type (refund, return, damaged product) be useful?
A: Yes, especially when analyzing refunds, because they affect my financial reports directly..

Q7: Would exporting complaint data into Excel or CSV be useful for you?
A: I think that any solution that would have a structured answer would be better than the current alternatives that we have.

Q8: Would search functionality help you find specific complaints or orders faster?
A: Yes, especially when checking specific orders during financial audits or reporting.

Interview 2 – Zalando User

Name: Eva Petrushevska
Age: 21
Occupation: University student
Shopping habits: Frequently shops online and uses discount codes

Questions & Answers

Q1: Have you ever experienced a problem with an online order?
A: Happily it did not happen to me, but I see that it is a common thing that happens to people online.

Q2: If you did have a problem how would you report it?
A: I would contact customer support through email or phone number if it is available.

Q3: What would be the most frustrating part of that process?
A: Waiting for a response.

Q4: Would it help if you could track the status of your complaint online?
A: Yes, it would make me feel more at ease since I would be able to see that they actually received it.

Q5: Would uploading screenshots/files when submitting a complaint be useful?
A: Only in cases when showing proof of an issue.

Q6: Would it be useful to search for your complaints in your account instead of scrolling through emails?
A: Yes, that would make it easier to find and track status of complaints.

Interview 3 – Zalando User

Name: Alja Eremic
Age: 22
Occupation: University student
Shopping habits: Frequently shops online and uses discount codes

Questions & Answers

Q1: Have you ever experienced a problem with an online order?
A: Yes, once I received the wrong size of shoes.

Q2: How did you approach the problem?
A: I first checked the help section of the website and then I sent an email, but it wasn't very helpful.

Q3: What is the most frustrating part of that process?
A: Waiting for a response, not knowing if the email address is even correct.

Q4: Would it help if you could track the status of your complaint online?
A: Well, yes but still I would prefer the process itself to be just faster.

Q5: Would uploading screenshots/files when submitting a complaint be useful?
A: Not really, but I guess for some people it would be a nice thing.

Q6: Would it be useful to search for your complaints in your account instead of scrolling through emails?
A: I guess yes, if you have multiple complaints at once.

Conclusions

The interviews confirm that the main hypotheses are valid.

- The **accountant** needs structured complaint data, filtering and search features to handle refunds efficiently and reduce manual work.

- **Zalando users** want faster responses and the ability to search their complaints instead of relying on emails.

Overall, both employees and customers would benefit from a **centralized system**, and the interviews highlighted **search functionality** as an important improvement for the prototype.

Link to our Prototype:

https://femur-push-29224551.figma.site/